

**Section 1 (Please tell us about yourself - a brief description about your interest and hobbies?
(Maximum 300 words):**

I didn't always want to study public health. Honestly, I didn't even know what it was until my grandmother got sick.

I was seventeen when she was admitted to a hospital with what started as a simple stomach infection. But the real illness wasn't just the infection — it was the chaos around it: overcrowded wards, nurses who were too exhausted to explain anything, and a discharge summary so vague that we didn't know whether to give her fluids or prayers. She survived, but something in me shifted. I realized that individual medical care only goes so far. The system around it matters more.

That experience quietly rewired my hobbies. Now, instead of just scrolling through my phone, I find myself reading public health memoirs and outbreak investigations — my current favorite is about how a contaminated water pump changed London's understanding of cholera. On weekends, I volunteer at a small community kitchen near my home. It's not glamorous work, but listening to people's stories while serving meals taught me that food safety, sanitation, and dignity are all connected.

When I need to breathe, I go for long walks — sometimes with a podcast on maternal health, sometimes just with my own thoughts. I've also picked up amateur gardening. Watching seeds turn into saplings taught me patience and prevention: two things public health is built on.

So yes, my hobbies are quiet: reading, serving, walking, planting. But they all trace back to one hospital room — and a grandmother who deserved better.

Section 2 (Describe how the scholarship will enable you to access your desired Aston postgraduate programme, which may not have been possible without the financial support? (Maximum 300 words):

Let me be honest with you — without this scholarship, Aston wouldn't feel like a real possibility. It would feel like a beautiful dream I'm afraid to touch.

I come from a background where higher education abroad has always been seen as a luxury, not a next step. My family supports me with everything they have — emotionally, morally, endlessly — but financially, they simply cannot carry the weight of international tuition and living costs. And I've never wanted them to. That's why I've worked since my undergraduate days, saved what I could, and avoided asking for more than they can give.

But here's the quiet truth I've learned: hard work alone doesn't open every door. Sometimes, you need a hand — not because you're incapable, but because the system wasn't built for people like you.

This scholarship would be that hand. It wouldn't just pay fees; it would unlock access to Aston's MPH programme — access to world-class faculty, to research on health inequalities, to a network of peers who think globally and act locally. Without it, I'd likely spend the next few years piecing together affordable online courses, hoping they somehow add up to the kind of rigorous training Aston offers.

But with it? I could stand in a lecture hall, ask real questions, collect real data, and return home not just with a degree — but with the tools to rebuild something meaningful in my own community.

So no, this isn't about comfort or convenience. It's about access. And access changes everything.

Section 3 (What are your career aspirations post study and how will the intended postgraduate Aston programme open your job opportunities? (Maximum 300 words)):

I don't just want a job after this degree. I want a mission — and I'm already on my way.

For the past few years, I've been working as a Food Safety Officer and Quality Assurance Supervisor at CWAY Foods and Beverages. That role taught me something no classroom could: that public health isn't abstract. It's checking water quality at 7 a.m., it's tracing a contamination source before hundreds of products leave the factory, it's explaining to a production team why one skipped step could make a child sick. I loved the responsibility, but I also hit a ceiling.

I saw how many health risks — foodborne illnesses, poor sanitation, weak regulatory enforcement — keep recurring because there's no one connecting the dots between industry practice and population-level policy. I want to be that person.

That's where Aston comes in. The MPH programme will give me the epidemiology, data analysis, and health systems training I currently lack. I won't just know how to inspect a factory; I'll know how to design interventions that prevent outbreaks across entire regions. Employers like WHO, national health ministries, and global food safety bodies don't just want experience — they want experience backed by rigorous public health training. Aston gives me that credibility.

Short term after graduation? I hope to move into a public health officer or food safety policy role with an NGO or government body. Long term? I want to lead programmes that integrate food safety into broader public health systems — because safe food isn't a luxury. It's the first line of defense.

Aston won't just open new doors. It will give me the key to walk through them.